

UC BERKELEY HAAS

INSIDER TIPS



ABOUT HAAS

The Berkeley Haas mission is “to develop leaders who redefine how we do business.” Its distinctive culture is framed by four principles: Question the status quo, confidence without attitude, students always, beyond yourself. Haas aims to cultivate innovative leaders who know how to put new ideas to work and to do so responsibly. By leveraging the energy that’s ever-present in the innovative business ecosystem of the San Francisco Bay Area, the program emphasizes how to seize opportunities, challenge conventional wisdom and act creatively. Quips the website, “our entire culture is about fresh thinking. This is Berkeley, after all.”

Anchored in a rigorous general management curriculum, the program aims to impart multidimensional leadership skills that can be applied in any type of organization, including global firms, startups, nonprofits, or graduates’ own entrepreneurial ventures. Haas links its courses and programs across disciplines at Berkeley and puts a premium on flexibility, allowing students to customize a program of study to their interests and design their own electives.

STRENGTHS & SPECIALIZATIONS

Nonprofit/Social Responsibility, Entrepreneurship, Technology, Innovation, International Management, Healthcare, General Management, Organizational Behavior

KEY STATS

MBA RANKINGS*	2017	2018	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023
BusinessWeek	11	6	8	8	*	*	14
Financial Times	13	10	10	12	*	14	7
US News	7	7	6	7	7	7	11
Poets and Quants	9	8	8	8	9	9	10

INCOMING CLASS

Number of Applicants	3,183	Avg Age	28
MBA Class Size	247	Avg GMAT	729
Total Tuition	US\$152,866	Avg GPA	3.64
		% International	41%
		% Women	46%

POST-MBA CAREERS

Technology	32.9%
Consulting	28.2%
Financial Services	13.7%
Healthcare & Consumer Products	5.1%
Starting Own Business	5%

TOP RECRUITERS INCLUDE:

Adobe, Amazon, Bain & Company, BCG, Cisco, Cruise Automation, Deloitte, EY-Parthenon, Google, McKinsey, Meta, Nike, PwC Strategy&, ServiceNow

AVERAGE BASE SALARY:	US\$152,831
SALARY INCREASE:	132%
EMPLOYED IN 3 MONTHS:	93.8%



TOP TIPS FOR ACING YOUR HAAS APPLICATION

BY SHARON JOYCE

With over 25 years of experience in admissions and student affairs, Sharon is a seasoned professional in higher education who has been lauded for her innovative approaches in streamlining interview processes at multiple institutions and her efforts to create inclusive communities in graduate education. At UC Berkeley's Haas School of Business, she served as the Associate Director of Admissions for the full-time program MBA program, while also collaborating on the overall strategic plan for Haas admissions as a member of the Senior Management team.



Through the essays, the Admissions Committee is seeking to uncover the less visible forces that shape candidates' lives, opportunities, decisions, and character.

1

THE FOUR LEADERSHIP PRINCIPLES ARE A REAL THING

The four principles – Question the Status Quo, Confidence Without Attitude, Students Always, and Beyond Yourself – are truly reflective of the school’s culture and not just marketing fodder. Prepare to demonstrate how and why these principles speak to you. In the Haas interview, for example, you may be asked which one resonates most. There isn’t a right or wrong reply to this and it’s not a trick, but your ability to be authentic and honest in response depends on whether you’ve taken the time to get introspective about both the principles and your fit with the program.

DIVERSITY OF CULTURES AND PERSPECTIVES IS PARAMOUNT

2

The school is committed to recruiting the most diverse students, faculty, and staff to enhance the mission, community, and academic excellence. Through the essays, the Admissions Committee is seeking to uncover the less visible forces that shape candidates’ lives, opportunities, decisions, and character. Express your values, political engagement, awareness of social justice, and/or access to education in terms of social mobility – all of which are very important to Haas. This school seeks students who demonstrate self-awareness and community engagement, which is an invitation to recognize your privilege and convey a deep understanding of what that means to you. Haas genuinely fosters a climate of inclusion, empathy, and compassion. Even if you don’t identify as a member of a marginalized group, it can be valuable to show how you are an ally and welcoming of different ways of thinking, which ties to Questioning the Status Quo and Beyond Yourself.

3

PRIDE IN BEING PART OF A WORD-RECOGNIZED PUBLIC INSTITUTION

It's important to demonstrate some awareness that Berkeley Haas is part of the University of California system, with Berkeley being its flagship campus. The University of California was founded in 1868, born out of a vision in the State Constitution of a university that would "contribute even more than California's gold to the glory and happiness of advancing generations." UC Berkeley students – Haas students included – are reputed to be "scrappier" than peers at private institutions as well as lauded by recruiters for being less "entitled," which ties directly to the Confidence Without Attitude principle.

IT'S OKAY TO BE A LITTLE BIT "BEZERKELEY"

4

The term "Beserkeley" has a history in popular culture and media lingo. In 2004, the current top definition for the word "Bezerkeley," a popular spelling variant of the word, was created on Urban Dictionary. The word as read on the site is defined simply as "Berkeley, California," as if the name of the city alone were enough to express the out-there atmosphere associated with the locale. How does this apply to Berkeley Haas? The Admissions Committee does place some value on being a bit quirky – if this is authentically who you are. (But don't fake it if you're not!) The acceptance of those who might have taken a path less traveled, or who have an unusual talent or hobby, is what makes the Haas student body so unique. The essay prompts tend to be less conventional by design; the admissions committee wants to find out what makes you tick, up and beyond your work and academic acumen. You should approach the prompts with enthusiasm, gusto and as a signal of your fit for the program.

5

COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT IS REQUISITE

The student-driven and deeply participatory atmosphere at Haas is another vital differentiator to connect to your narrative. Haas's culture of engagement extends beyond studies into institutional operations, with feedback loops between student government and every administrative function/office within the program. Student viewpoints are taken very seriously and are actively solicited. Admissions interviews are predominately conducted by student interviewers, for example, and their reviews of candidates are weighed equally to those conducted by alumni and professional staff.

As such, if you're among the fortunate to be invited to interview, know that current students, who serve as interviewers, can be tough evaluators. You will need to cite two-to-three clubs you plan to join at Haas, as well as link at least one club with experience or position you've served in the past to demonstrate your commitment, sincerity and track record of community engagement. So earlier on in the application process, be sure to reach out to student leadership to have a few examples of how you'll be an active participant.

Read insider essay strategies for Berkeley Haas [here](#).

DEADLINES & DATES

	APPLICATION DEADLINE	DECISION NOTIFICATION
1st Deadline	14 September 2023	07 December 2023
2nd Deadline	04 January 2024	21 March 2024
3rd Deadline	28 March 2024	02 May 2024



**The best time to
apply is when you're
ready.**

Caroline Diarte Edwards,
Co-Founder & Director of Fortuna Admissions

LET'S GET YOU IN.

Fortuna Admissions is a dream team of former MBA Admissions Directors and Officers from the top-tier business schools, including Wharton, INSEAD, Harvard Business School, Stanford GSB, Kellogg, LBS, Chicago Booth, MIT Sloan, Columbia, NYU Stern, IE, Duke Fuqua, UCLA Anderson, Yale SOM, Cornell Johnson and Berkeley Haas.

As industry experts, we regularly provide commentary and analysis about b-school admissions for major media around the world. To read our full range of advice visit: FortunaAdmissions.com

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